



National Continuity Training Program Instructor Cadre Requirements and Approval Process

THE FOLLOWING INFORMATION ESTABLISHES THE REQUIREMENTS, STANDARDS, AND APPROVAL PROCESS FOR INSTRUCTORS SUPPORTING THE DELIVERY OF NATIONAL CONTINUITY PROGRAMS' (NCP) CONTINUITY COURSES.

INSTRUCTOR REQUIREMENTS AND STANDARDS

Minimum Instructor Requirements

National Continuity Training Program (NCTP) instructors must have subject-area expertise and proven successful teaching experience for the courses they teach. At a minimum, instructors must meet the following criteria:

- Have continuity responsibilities in their current day-to-day job (as demonstrated by resume);
- Possess a Continuity Excellence Series Certification: Master Continuity Practitioner, Continuity Planner Certificate, or Continuity Program Manager Certificate;
 - Master Continuity Practitioners and Continuity Program Managers are eligible to instruct E/L 1301 and E/L 1302.
 - Continuity Planners are eligible to instruct E/L 1301.
- Completed Instructional Presentation and Evaluation Skills Course (E/L 141), Instructor Training Certification (PER-266), or equivalent. (Equivalent instructional methodology courses will be reviewed on a case by case basis);
- Completed E/L 1301 or E/L 1302 Train-the-Trainer (TtT) Workshop;
- Receive written approval from NCTP upon completion of the Electronic Application Process (outlined below); and
- Instructors must instruct twice per calendar year to maintain approval.

Electronic Application Process

The application process to become a lead or assistant instructor is completed in two parts: an electronic application submission and a virtual training demonstration. Applicant instructors should submit the following documentation to the FEMA-Continuity-Practitioner@fema.dhs.gov email box:

- Cover letter listing the courses requesting approval to instruct;
- Resume outlining continuity experience;
- Documentation necessary to demonstrate meeting the minimum instructor requirements (e.g. MCP certificate);
- Email or letter of approval from FEMA Regional Continuity Manager (RCM) or designee; and
- A 30-minute teaching demonstration video or a request for live virtual demonstration appointment.
 - All training demonstrations must use a slide deck provided by NCTP.

NCTP staff will review the electronic application submission for completeness to include the instructor's demonstrated continuity background/experience and approval from the RCM for

the FEMA Region in which the instructor would like to teach. Upon approval of the electronic application, a panel review of the instructor's teaching demonstration will be scheduled. NCTP will schedule at least one panel review per month for up to eight instructors. Each panel will consist of no less than three subject matter experts identified by NCTP in the areas of continuity and training, and may include Training Managers, NCP staff, RCMs, or other Regional staff. Teaching demonstrations will be evaluated using the attached rubric. Applicant instructors will receive written notice of approval from NCTP within five business days of the panel review.

For the teaching demonstration, instruction will be evaluated based on the following criteria:

- Establish and Maintain Professional Credibility
- Manage an Environment that Fosters Learning and Performance
- Communicate Effectively
- Demonstrate Effective Presentation Skills
- Demonstrate Effective Questioning Skills
- Respond Appropriately to Learners' Needs for Clarification or Feedback
- Stimulate and Sustain Learner Motivation and Engagement
- Plan Instructional Methods and Materials

Instructor Standards

Instructors are expected to deliver courses professionally and to a high level of quality. Responsibilities include:

- Maintain current continuity expertise by reviewing updated policies, guidance, training materials, and other continuity related documents;
- Instruct to the materials, not to the test to ensure standard delivery throughout the nation;
- Coordinate with other instructors, the Course Requester, and NCTP regarding course questions or details;
- Maintain professional dress and demeanor;
- Prepare for course delivery (reviewing/rehearsing course material, reviewing course instruction and schedule, etc.);
- Arrange and test all classroom setup/functionality, including audio/video testing; table and chair configuration; whiteboards/easels; course documents; and directional signage. When traveling out of the NCR or on authorized travel (orders), Lead Instructors will ensure the classroom is properly setup and all visual or audio connectivity are properly working;
- Remain attentive and engaged during the entirety of the course, even if your module is not being presented;
- Solicit and listen to feedback, including from other instructors after each day;
- Thank the students at course completion and offer contact information should any student seek to follow up with additional questions; and
- Instructors should honor commitments and communicate schedule conflict risks as soon as they are known (such as personal emergencies, deployments, or other exceptional circumstances).

- If a conflict arises or has the potential to occur; the instructor will notify their supervisor, the RCM, and/or NCTP as soon as possible;
- All NCP staff will coordinate with their supervisor and NCTP when asked to instruct training in the NCR, within their region, or outside of their region. NCTP will coordinate with the instructors and supervisor to ensure their availability and the availability of travel funds.

Lead and Assistant Instructors

Only instructors that meet NCP's established qualifications may serve as Lead Instructors for scheduled NCP courses. Assistant Instructors are either qualified instructors or instructors-in-training who have completed all of NCP's prerequisite coursework and are completing their required teaching experience under the oversight of a Lead Instructor.

Lead Instructor	Assistant Instructor
An individual who has overall responsibility for the delivery of NCP courses. Responsibilities include coordinating with the Course Requestor (if different than the Lead Instructor) and ensuring all logistical tasks associated with the course are performed. The Lead Instructor coordinates curriculum delivery for the course with assigned assistant instructors. The Lead Instructor is accountable for completing all documentation. All course instructors must meet NCP's qualification requirements.	A qualified instructor who supports a Lead Instructor in course delivery. The number of assistant instructors needed varies by course (usually one, no more than two, resulting in no more than three instructors total). Assistant instructors work under the oversight of the Lead Instructor to deliver the assigned training modules. All course instructors must meet NCP's qualification requirements.
• Complete the "Green Sheet" • Develop a Training Announcement • Determine: ○ Registration ○ Classroom set up ○ Audio/Visual ○ Course materials or handouts ○ Participant Feedback Forms • Collect and turn in EMI applications and course evaluations • Assign units to Assistant Instructor(s) • Conduct course according to materials	• Participate in communications check • Assist in breakout groups, class discussion, and activities • Instruct a minimum of two units • Assist with student check-in • Support student questions during breaks and before/after class • Assist with providing materials, links, and additional information as needed • Troubleshoot issues as they arise •

*This list is a sample of instructor responsibilities. See the instructor checklist for a more complete list.

Quality Assurance Visits

NCP reserves the right to monitor the quality of all NCP course delivery and may periodically send representatives to conduct quality assurance visits to ensure instructors are meeting delivery standards outlined in this section. Additionally, course evaluations will be reviewed regularly by NCTP staff to ensure quality instruction.

Train-the-Trainer Workshop

NCPT will produce and teach a TtT Workshop for each course that requires instructors. The TtT Workshop is one component of the Instructor Cadre certification requirements.

Approved Instructor Database

NCTP maintains a list of all current instructors authorized to provide in-person or virtual training. NCTP can assist Regions with an instructor search using the certified instructor database. State and local stakeholders should coordinate with their RCM to schedule training and access certified instructors located within the Region (if needed). Regions may be required to cover travel costs for instructors.

The database will be updated monthly and after each TtT Workshop and distributed to the RCMs.

Teaching Demonstration Evaluation Rubric		Date
Instructor (Last, First)		Time (Start/Stop)
Observation Type In-Person ☐ Virtual ☐ (Web-cam required) Video ☐		

Competency	3 - Exceeds	2 - Meets	1 - Does not meet	Score
<i>Establish and Maintain Professional Credibility</i>	☐ Introduces oneself at the beginning of class and describes background and expertise in continuity ☐ Is extremely well informed about the subject and its applications ☐ Displays exemplary confidence and comfort with the materials ☐ Sets the tone for a positive learning environment at the beginning of the course ☐ Uses the Instructor's Guide as a guide and not as a script, demonstrating familiarity with the materials ☐ Displays appropriate professional attire	☐ Introduces oneself without describing background and expertise in continuity ☐ Is well informed about the subject and its applications ☐ Displays confidence and comfort with the materials ☐ Creates a positive atmosphere for learning ☐ Heavily relies on the Instructor's Guide as a script demonstrating unfamiliarity with the materials ☐ Professional attire could be improved	☐ Does not introduce oneself or describe their background and expertise in continuity ☐ Is informed about the subject and its applications but may give vague information, seem tentative, be tied to notes, misinforms, or confuses the class ☐ Displays little confidence, or seems extremely nervous or hesitant and is highly distracting in behavior ☐ Displays self-confidence but makes little effort to establish learner confidence, makes offensive comments, or dismisses learners' points of view ☐ Does not display appropriate professional attire	

Competency	3 - Exceeds	2 - Meets	1 - Does not meet	Score
<i>Manage an Environment that Fosters Learning and Performance</i>	☐ Encourages participation through sharing information and experience ☐ Effectively adapts instruction to learners' needs, giving individual attention while maintaining the group's learning process ☐ Manages time and activities exceedingly well, ensuring learners' progress toward the stated objectives	☐ Encourages participation sparingly ☐ Adapts instruction to learners' needs, giving individual attention without seriously interrupting the group's learning process ☐ Manages time and activities well, facilitating learners' progress toward the stated objectives	☐ Involves learners in a superficial or limited way, or makes little or no effort to involve learners ☐ Displays minimal evidence of adapting instruction to meet individual or group needs ☐ Manages time and group interactions adequately at times, poorly at other times, i.e. rushes instruction or is tediously slow throughout ☐ Allows a few to dominate the group ☐ Fails to link instruction to learners' needs	
<i>Communicate Effectively</i>	☐ Has excellent language skills ☐ Uses body language and pauses to extend and enhance communication ☐ Effectively relates content to learners' experience ☐ Is constantly aware of how well learners are comprehending	☐ Has good language skills ☐ Uses body language and pauses to help communicate ☐ Appropriately relates content to learners' experiences ☐ Is generally aware of how well learners are comprehending	☐ Weak language skills or lacks basic language skills ☐ Displays body language or pauses that sometimes or frequently interfere with communication ☐ Relates content to learners' experience in a limited way or fails to link content to learners' experience ☐ Is sometimes aware of how well learners are comprehending or generally ignores the learners	

Competency	3 - Exceeds	2 - Meets	1 - Does not meet	Score
<i>Demonstrate Effective Presentation Skills</i>	☐ Speaks very clearly and consistently in an audible voice with a variety of inflections, stimulating learner interest ☐ Makes frequent eye contact with individual learners ☐ Presents instruction in an engaging, coherent, well-organized sequence ☐ Makes use of props, humor, and examples that are particularly effective for the class ☐ Uses natural and non-distracting gestures and movements	☐ Speaks clearly in a modulated voice that helps sustain learner interest ☐ Looks frequently at the class ☐ Presents instruction in an organized, coherent sequence ☐ Uses props, stories, etc., that are clearly appropriate for the class	☐ Speaks clearly, but the vocal quality, modulation or pacing does not adequately help sustain learner interest or speaks in a voice that adversely affects the learners' understanding and interest ☐ Looks occasionally at the class or rarely looks at the learners ☐ Presents instruction in sequence but is occasionally disorganized and/or confusing or presents instruction in a disorganized way ☐ May use props, examples, etc. that are only somewhat useful or relevant or uses props, examples, etc. in an inappropriate or confusing way	
<i>Demonstrate Effective Questioning Skills</i>	☐ Skillfully asks and directs a variety of questions to build confidence and promote learning ☐ Encourages early participation through questioning ☐ Listens carefully and attentively to learners ☐ Effectively rephrases or repeats questions when necessary	☐ Asks a variety of relevant questions and directs them appropriately ☐ Listens carefully to learners ☐ Phrases or repeats questions clearly when necessary	☐ Asks few questions or fails to ask questions ☐ Asks generally trivial undirected questions or asks questions that are unclear or irrelevant ☐ Allows questioning but does not seem to encourage it or seems to discourage learners from asking questions ☐ Seems unaware of learners' needs	

Competency	3 - Exceeds	2 - Meets	1 - Does not meet	Score
<i>Respond Appropriately to Learners' Needs for Clarification or Feedback</i>	☐ Creates an environment in which individuals confidently seek clarification as needed ☐ Helps learners clarify request when necessary ☐ Always gives specific, helpful responses ☐ Assesses learners' progress at well-timed points	☐ Encourages learners to ask questions when necessary ☐ Is aware of learners' needs ☐ Gives consistently clear and helpful responses ☐ Assesses learners' progress at appropriate opportunities	☐ Does little to identify those who need help or discourages learners from asking for help ☐ Gives superficial or non-specific feedback or gives little or no positive feedback ☐ Does not always listen carefully or always give relevant responses or gives vague or confusing answers ☐ Monitors learner progress inadequately (e.g. rarely checks progress, assesses only some of the learners, or uses somewhat inappropriate evaluation techniques) or does not monitor progress	
<i>Stimulate and Sustain Learner Motivation and Engagement</i>	☐ Skillfully presents module's objectives and explains how they relate to the learners ☐ Uses relevant, highly motivational activities or information to introduce new topics ☐ Discusses purpose and usefulness of material being presented ☐ Gives specific, positive feedback	☐ Clearly presents objectives for the module and explains how they relate to the learners ☐ Uses relevant, motivational activities or information to introduce new topics ☐ Gives positive feedback	☐ Presents module's objectives but may not communicate their relevance or fails to state objectives or convey the importance of what is being taught ☐ Rarely motivates learners when introducing new topics ☐ Glosses over problems or gives gratuitous praise ☐ Gives limited positive feedback, usually of a general nature or rarely gives positive feedback	

Competency	3 - Exceeds	2 - Meets	1 - Does not meet	Score
<i>Plan Instructional Methods and Materials</i>	☐ Makes smooth transitions, seamlessly adjusting techniques as needed ☐ Makes relevant, highly effective connections across topics and summarizes key points at well-timed intervals	☐ Makes fairly smooth transitions, adjusting techniques as needed ☐ Makes relevant connections across topics and summarizes appropriately	☐ Makes transitions/adjusts techniques infrequently or in an awkward or confusing way ☐ Makes minimal connection across topics	
Overall Rating ☐ Recommend approval as Lead Instructor ☐ Recommend approval as Assistant Instructor ☐ Not Ready to Instruct Independently Comments:			Final Score Scoring Metrics: 19-24: Consistently Exceeds Expectations 13-18: Consistently Meets Expectations 0-12: Does Not Consistently Meet Expectations	